

3.6 Mice

3.6.1 CPI / DPI

Short for Counts per Inch / Dots Per Inch, this is the number of unique points that can be detected by the sensor in one square inch area. The greater this value, the greater the capability of the mouse to detect movements (sensitivity).

3.6.2 Laser Mouse

This is the latest innovation in pointing technology. Moving a step ahead of the optical mouse, which uses normal light, the Laser mouse uses an infrared Laser beam (from a Laser Emitting Diode) to illuminate the surface. A laser sensitive sensor is then used to track changes in the surface. Due to the focussed nature of the laser beam, the Laser mouse can achieve 20 times the sensitivity of the optical mouse, besides being able to detect differences on surfaces that befuddle an optical mouse.

3.6.3 Mechanical Mouse

This mouse uses a ball to rotate two slit disks placed in the X and Y axis. The slit disks are placed between a set of light source and optical sensor. Any rotation of the disk causes a the slits to cut the beam of light received by the sensor which is translated into changes in the respective axis. Any movement of the ball is thus translated into changes in the X and Y axis. Mechanical mice are on the way out due to the advantages offered by the equally priced optical mice.

3.6.4 Mouse Driver

Usually the default driver offers the basic functionality of a 2 button scroll wheel mouse. To use the features of the mouse optimally, the driver created specifically for the mouse needs to be installed. The mouse driver allows the buttons on the mouse to be reconfigured.

3.6.5 Optical Mouse

The Optical mouse employs a camera or optical sensor to constantly take images of the surface beneath the mouse. Any changes in the surface is detected and the differences in the x and y posi-